SAP MM: Release Strategy Configuration Guide

Purchase Order release procedure with a sample value-based example | Author: Manikandan S

1. Purpose

A release strategy (release procedure) makes sure a Purchase Requisition or Purchase Order is approved by the right people before it can be processed further. The strategy is chosen automatically when document values match the conditions set in classification. This guide shows the standard configuration for a Purchase Order, using dummy values.

2. Building blocks

Element	Meaning
Characteristic	A field from the PO header (structure CEKKO), such as net order value, purchasing group or document type. Used as a condition.
Class (type 032)	Groups the characteristics. The class is assigned to the release group.
Release group	Links a class to a set of release strategies.
Release code	Identifies an approver or approval level (for example L1, L2).
Release indicator	Shows the status of the document while it is in the release process (for example blocked, released).
Release strategy	A combination of release codes, prerequisites, release statuses and classification values.

3. Configuration steps

Path: SPRO > Materials Management > Purchasing > Purchase Order > Release Procedure for Purchase Orders

Step	Activity	T-code / location
1	Create characteristics, e.g. GNETW (net order value) from CEKKO, and optionally EKGRP (purchasing group)	CT04
2	Create a class of class type 032 and assign the characteristics	CL02
3	Define the release procedure: release groups, release codes, release indicators	SPRO: Set Up Procedure with Classification
4	Create release strategies: assign codes, prerequisites and release statuses	SPRO: Release Strategies
5	Maintain classification: enter the value range for each strategy	Classification button in the strategy
6	Assign workflow if e-mail or inbox approval is required	Workflow settings in the procedure

4. Sample strategy (dummy values)

Strategy	Net order value (INR)	Codes needed	Result
A1	0 to 50,000	L1 (Section Head)	PO released after L1 approval
A2	50,001 to 500,000	L1, then L2 (Plant Head)	PO released after L1 and L2
A3	Above 500,000	L1, L2, then L3 (Director)	PO released after all three

Release prerequisites define the order: L2 can release only after L1, L3 only after L2.

5. How the PO behaves

- The strategy is determined when the PO is saved, based on the classification values.

- Until fully released, the PO is blocked: it cannot be printed or sent, and goods receipt is not allowed (depending on the release indicator setting).
- Approvers release through ME28 (collective) or ME29N (individual), or the corresponding Fiori app.
- If the PO value is changed after release beyond the set limit (change release setting), the release can be reset and the approval cycle restarts.

6. Testing checklist

Test	Expected result
Create a PO below the lowest limit	Strategy A1 is assigned; one approval needed
Create a PO in the middle range	Strategy A2 is assigned; two approvals in sequence
Try to release at L2 before L1	System does not allow it (prerequisite)
Increase value on a released PO	Release is reset when the change tolerance is exceeded
Try goods receipt before release	Blocked, if the release indicator is set that way

7. Troubleshooting: strategy not triggering

- Check that the PO header values match a strategy exactly: document type, purchasing group, plant and value range.
- Verify that the class and characteristics are assigned to the correct release group.
- Check that the release group is linked to the right document category (PO, not PR).
- Make sure the value used is the net value in the currency the strategy expects.
- Look at the release strategy tab in ME23N to see which strategy, if any, was found.
- After a configuration change, test with a new PO: existing POs keep their old strategy.

All values, names and codes are dummy examples for learning. Real strategies depend on company approval policy.